

Beaconhouse National University



Assignment: Reading 2.1

Subject: Functional English

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Section: B

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How to Reduce Carbon Footprint in Textile Industry

There's been a 6% rise in greenhouse gas emissions in 2010 and the majority of it comes from china, usa and india. There are many reasons for GHG emissions like consumption of fuels, manufactured goods, materials, wood, roads, services, and textile industry which one can say is one of the biggest contributors to climate change and global warming.

Cotton is one of the most used natural fibers and it is a cash crop. There is more to it than just jeans and t-shirts. Did you know that cotton consumes about 20,000 liters of water which is estimated to be 5500 gallons. But wait there's more, 24% of global insecticide sales occur whereas cotton only covers 2.4% of the world's crop land. This heavy pesticide usage in cotton farming can have detrimental effects on ecosystems and human health.

But when comparing cotton to other synthetic materials, cotton is a more environmentally friendly option. Another common fabric used in clothing is polyester which showed way higher emissions (706 billion kg of CO₂e in 2015) because it's derived from fossil fuels like crude oil. A single polyester t-shirt is estimated to have emissions of 5.5 kg CO₂e, while a cotton t-shirt has lower emissions at 2.1 kg CO₂e.

To help reduce carbon emission we should use alternative fabrics, materials such as flax, hemp and spider silk can improve sustainability.

My Views

There should be a balance between all types of fabrics. There should be laws regarding plantation of cash crops which would only be seasonal and in terms of demand and supply. There should also be awareness of other fabrics and governments should give incentives to companies which adopt policies and products which help sustain the environment and reduce GHG emissions.

My Questions

Why is there little to no awareness when it comes to the textile industry?

Why doesn't the government proactively engage with companies to come to reasonable consensus and ideas for the betterment of everyone?

Sources

<https://www.co2nsensus.com/blog/how-to-reduce-carbon-footprint-in-textile-industry>